

SLS Annual Assembly 2026

What SLS achieved in 2026, told by the members who achieved it, and the people who made it possible named in front of everyone. The experience carries the content, not the reverse.

DATE	TIME	VENUE	ROOM	NOT THIS YEAR
Saturday, December 12, 2026	6:30 to 10:30 p.m.	City Hub	300 members	No graduation segment

01 Show the year. Name the people who made it.

Purpose

The Assembly is the one evening the whole society is in a single room. Two things need that room: the year's achievements, set out properly, and the partners, Council members, Chapter teams and contributors who delivered them, recognized in front of everyone.

Everything else is in service of those two. That gives the agenda a simple test: if a segment does not connect to somebody in the room, it comes out.

02 The brief every segment is tested against

What members leave with

THINKING	FEELING	DOING, WITHIN A WEEK
I can name three things this society delivered in 2026.	Proud of the company I am in. Not flattered, proud.	Repeats one SLS achievement to someone outside the room.
What I contributed was seen, by name, in front of everyone.	Known. Someone in that room knows my name and what I worked on.	Says yes to one named thing for 2027.
I know what 2027 asks of me, and it is specific.	Impatient to start. Next year sounds worth being part of.	

03 Three things the evening has to land

Key messages

- 1 SLS is a working network, not a membership list.
- Every achievement shown has a member's name on it.

2 The society sees who does the work.

Contribution is recognized publicly and specifically, never thanked in the abstract.

3 2027 asks something of you by name.

Not "get involved" but a defined commitment, made before members leave.

04

The content

The year's achievements, at two depths

This is the strongest part of the evening and the part that does not exist yet. Nobody has assembled what SLS delivered in 2026 in one place, and everything on stage depends on it.

The gallery, at the entrance. The full year laid out to walk through during the first fifty minutes: every chapter, every initiative, every number. Members browse at their own pace and find their own work. This is where volume lives.

Three stories, on stage. Twenty-five minutes, three members telling what happened to them rather than a milestone review read from a deck. The test for choosing them: a member did it, not the Foundation; the outcome fits in one sentence with a number in it; and it would not have happened without the society.

The SLS team compiles it, not the membership. Four categories: what members built, what Chapters delivered, how the society grew, and where SLS showed up. The team works from its own records and goes to Chapter leads only to close gaps. The same exercise produces the recognition citations, so nothing is asked twice and the members are asked nothing at all.

This is the critical path. Nothing on stage can be written until the year is compiled. Start this month, finish with the planning phase on **November 19**.

05

Recognition

Three volumes, because sixty names is not a ceremony

Partners, Council, Chapter teams and contributors together are likely sixty-plus names. A queue of sixty walks to a stage would take most of the evening and land on the item the 2024 survey scored lowest. So recognition runs at three volumes.

The Wall of the Year

EVERYONE · AT THE ENTRANCE, ALL EVENING

Every partner, Council member, Chapter team and contributor named, grouped by what they did rather than by rank, alongside the gallery. Sixty names honored in the time it takes to walk in.

Two moments on stage

FOUR GROUPS · 8:05 AND 9:25

Partners and Chapter teams before the break, the Council and the honor after the keynote. Chapter teams go up as *teams*, since six people together for ninety seconds beats six separate walks. Each name carries **one specific line**: what

they did and what it produced. "Thank you for your support" is worth nothing to an executive.

One honor

ONE · 9:25

The SLS team prepares the shortlist and the citation from the year it has just compiled, and the Council approves it. Members are chief executives; they are not sent nomination forms.

The letter home. A letter from SLS leadership to the board chair of each honored contributor's organization. Recognition that reaches a chief executive's board outlives anything they can put on a shelf, and it costs a signature.

06
Format and
program

Four hours, five things

WHEN	Saturday, December 12, 2026, 6:30 to 10:30 p.m. December puts the assembly at the year's end, which is what a year in review needs
WHERE	City Hub. Site survey still needed to confirm a stage, a seated 300, the gallery and dinner all work in one evening
WHO	SLS members: chief executives, VIPs and senior Saudi leaders. That sets the protocol standard, the bar for whoever takes the stage, and the rule that the SLS team does the work rather than the members
HOW MANY	300. The venue sets the ceiling, and it matches a realistic turnout: in 2024, 320 of 468 registrants attended, a 68% show rate. Invite the full membership, plan for 300 in the room, manage with an RSVP cap and a waitlist
BALANCE	120 minutes on stage, 120 on the floor. The longest seated stretch is 70 minutes, because in 2024 half the audience left after a long one
PRAYER	Isha (about 6:40 p.m.) falls inside the arrival window, so the program never stops for it

240 MINUTES · 120 ON STAGE

TIME SEGMENT

6:30 p.m. · 50' **Arrival, the gallery and the Wall**
The year laid out to walk through, every contributor named. Isha sits inside this window.

FLOOR
RECOGNITION

TIME	SEGMENT	
7:20 · 20'	Opening: the year, and what it means The Council chair sets out the three key messages and the headline of the year.	STAGE
7:40 · 25'	Three stories from the year Three members, told first-hand.	STAGE
8:05 · 25'	Recognition: partners and Chapter teams Named with citations. Teams called up as teams.	STAGE RECOGNITION
8:30 · 25'	Break on the floor Coffee, the gallery again, conversations. The one thing 2024 asked for most.	FLOOR
8:55 · 30'	Keynote dialogue Two chairs, a member moderating, questions prepared by the SLS team.	STAGE
9:25 · 20'	The Council: recognition, the honor, and 2027 Outgoing members recognized, the peer-nominated honor, then the direction for next year and the one commitment asked of members.	STAGE RECOGNITION
9:45 · 45'	Dinner and open networking Contributor names on screen throughout.	FLOOR
10:30 p.m.	Ends	

The keynote

No name yet; that is the Council's to nominate. The criteria matter more than the shortlist: someone this room will clear an evening for, who can speak to what a network like SLS makes possible rather than to their own career, and who will be *interviewed* rather than deliver a speech. In 2024 members asked specifically for shorter, more inspiring speaking and for leaders sharing experience over general advice.

A Vision 2030 delivery leader who has shipped a national program, interviewed by a member working on something adjacent. Closest to the theme, and my recommendation.

A global voice on a subject the membership is already discussing. Strongest draw, weakest link to the society.

A member of the society whose year stands out. Cheapest and most on-theme, least external pull.

Booking at this level needs eight to ten weeks, so the shortlist should close with the planning phase on November 19.

To be confirmed

CHARTER	SUB - CATEGORY	PRE - VAT
	Logistics: venue, build, stage, AV, F&B, signage	SAR xxx
	Events management: agency fee	SAR xxx
	Program delivery and content: stories, scripts, speakers, translation, recognition	SAR xxx
	Total for 300 guests	SAR xxx

The right anchor is the 2024 actuals, which EMU holds. Those set the range before the charter goes for approval.

And by when

SLS team, this month

- ☐ Compile the 2026 year from our own records, then go to Chapter leads only to close gaps. Nothing on stage can be written until this is done.
- ☐ Site survey at City Hub: does a stage, a seated 300, the gallery and dinner work in one evening there?
- ☐ Draft the honor shortlist and the citations, ready for Council approval.
- ☐ Open the keynote conversation. Booking at this level needs eight to ten weeks.

Decisions we need

- ☐ Confirm December 12 against the Council diary and the venue.
- ☐ Whether SLS already has named recognition categories. This note assumes not and proposes the structure from scratch.
- ☐ Council to approve the keynote and to confirm it will state a specific 2027 ask from the stage.
- ☐ Who signs the letter home, and to whom it goes.

By November 19: the year compiled, keynote confirmed, budget set against EMU's benchmark.

Companion to the SLS Annual Assembly 2026 event charter, in draft and pending approval. Benchmarks are from the 2024 post-event report: 468 registrants, 320 attendees, 76.8% overall satisfaction, agenda flow 69.8%. Venue capacity, layout and prayer times to be confirmed on site.